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CSS Flexbox Cheatsheet



Basic flex properties

CSS Flexbox is a one-dimensional layout system.

Property	Notes
<code>display</code>	<code>flex</code> or <code>inline-flex</code> establishes a flex formatting context.
<code>flex-direction</code>	Main axis direction: <code>row</code> , <code>row-reverse</code> , <code>column</code> , <code>column-reverse</code> .
<code>flex-wrap</code>	Whether items wrap: <code>nowrap</code> , <code>wrap</code> , <code>wrap-reverse</code> .
<code>flex-flow</code>	Shorthand for <code>flex-direction</code> and <code>flex-wrap</code> .
<code>gap</code>	Spacing between flex items.
<code>row-gap</code>	Spacing between rows when wrapped.
<code>column-gap</code>	Spacing between columns.
<code>order</code>	Controls visual order of a flex item.
<code>flex-grow</code>	How much an item grows relative to others.
<code>flex-shrink</code>	How much an item shrinks relative to others.
<code>flex-basis</code>	Initial size of an item before grow/shrink.
<code>flex</code>	Shorthand for <code>flex-grow</code> , <code>flex-shrink</code> , and <code>flex-basis</code> .
<code>align-self</code>	Overrides cross-axis alignment for a single item.

display

Turns an element into a flex container.

css



```
1 .container {  
2   display: flex; /* or inline-flex */  
3 }
```

flex-direction

Sets the main axis direction.

css



```
1 .container {  
2   display: flex;  
3   flex-direction: row; /* row | row-reverse | column | column-reverse */  
4 }
```

row

1

2

3

row-reverse

3

2

1

.....

column

1

2

3

column-reverse

3

2

1

flex-wrap

Controls whether items wrap onto multiple lines.

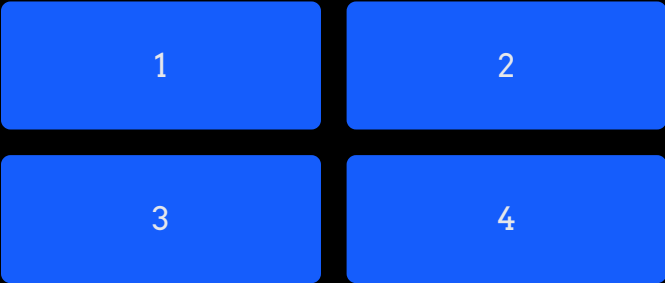
css



```
1  .container {  
2    display: flex;  
3    flex-wrap: wrap; /* nowrap | wrap | wrap-reverse */  
4  }
```

.....

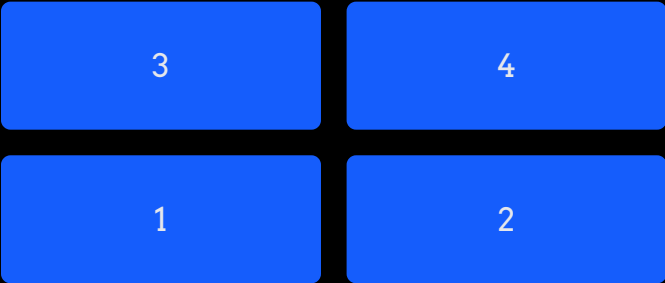
wrap



nowrap



wrap-reverse



flex-flow

Shorthand for `flex-direction` and `flex-wrap`.

css



```
1 .container {  
2   display: flex;  
3   flex-flow: row wrap;  
4 }
```

gap / row-gap / column-gap

Spacing between flex items.

css



```
1 .container {  
2   display: flex;  
3   gap: 16px;  
4 }
```

1

2

3

css



```
1 .container {  
2   display: flex;  
3   flex-wrap: wrap;  
4   row-gap: 12px;  
5   column-gap: 24px;  
6 }
```

1

2

3

4

order

Changes the visual order of a flex item.

css



```
1 .container {  
2   display: flex;  
3   gap: 16px;  
4 }  
5  
6 .item-first {  
7   order: -1; /* default is 0 */  
8 }
```

2 (first)

1

3

flex-grow

Controls how much an item grows relative to others.

css



```
1 .item-grow {  
2   flex-grow: 2; /* default is 0 */  
3 }
```



grow 2



flex-shrink

Controls how much an item shrinks relative to others.

css



```
1 .item-shrink {  
2   flex-shrink: 0; /* default is 1 */  
3 }
```



shrink 2



flex-basis

Sets the initial size of an item before grow/shrink.

css



```
1 .item-basis {  
2   flex-basis: 200px; /* default is auto */  
3 }
```

80px

160px

320px

flex

Shorthand for `flex-grow`, `flex-shrink`, and `flex-basis`.

css



```
1 .item {  
2   flex: 1 1 200px; /* flex: <grow> <shrink> <basis> */  
3 }
```